

IUTCONNECT

**FOSTERING COLLABORATION
AND CONNECTIVITY**

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PRESENTED BY The BYTERS



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Project Overview

IUT-CONNECT is a student-centered platform designed to connect IUT students and faculty through a unified digital space. It enables academic collaboration, peer support, research opportunities, and a campus marketplace—all in one simple, accessible application.

Benefits

- Makes communication seamless
- Provides peer-support and peer-to-peer communication
- Connects students and faculties for exciting research opportunities



SAMPLING STRATEGY DESIGN

Two Potential Populations:

Active Student Users: Students who frequently participate in projects, club activities, or job applications on campus.

System Access Logs: Automatically collected backend data showing login activity, usage frequency, and error messages.

Selected Population: Active Student Users

Chosen Sampling Method:Complex Random Stratified Sampling



Justification

1. We aim to ensure fair representation across key student subgroups (e.g., club leaders, project collaborators, job seekers).
2. Stratified sampling allows us to divide the population by roles and gather diverse insights.
3. It reduces bias, enhances inclusivity, and supports well-rounded design for IUTCONNECT.



Sampling Steps

Define subgroups:

1. Club participants
2. Project contributors
3. Job/research applicants

Collect filtered lists from relevant sources:

1. Club moderators, project coordinators, and the career development office
2. Stratify by department and academic year to ensure diversity
3. Randomly select 3–4 students per subgroup for balanced input
4. Send email invitations with study purpose and consent form



Investigation Plan for Existing Data

Data Source	Type	Description
System Error Logs	Quantitative	Backend logs of failed login attempts, page load times, and error events
Club Feedback Forms (manual)	Qualitative	Students' written feedback on usability and suggestions
Monthly Usage Reports	Quantitative	Admin reports on user activity, most used features, inactive users



Investigation Plan for Existing Data

Selected Source: Club Feedback Forms

- **Expected Insights:**

- Repeated feature requests (e.g., easier navigation, mobile support)
- Issues students face in uploading projects or finding job posts
- Requests for faculty interaction features and performance improvements

These insights will guide us to prioritize UX features, remove friction points, and align the system with student needs.



Observation Planning (Analyst's playscript)

Observed Role: Active Student User

Playscript (7 Steps):

- **Log In to the Platform** – Monitor login time, UI response, and error messages.
- **Update Profile** – Observe how students add skills, education, and interests.
- **Browse Projects** – Track interaction with filters, project details, and teams.
- **Apply to a Project** – Record actions for joining a team or messaging a lead.
- **Check Job Listings** – See how students interact with internship/research posts.
- **Send Message** – Watch process of starting a conversation with faculty or peers.
- **Log Out** – Note if user logs out manually or lets session time out.



STROBE Observation

Hypothetical Workspace: IUT Departmental Lab or Student Hall Room

Element	Observations
Office Location	Close to classrooms and labs, promoting academic-focused use
Desk Placement	Shared cubicles or hostel desks, often cluttered, affecting focus
Stationery	Minimal – mostly laptops, notebooks, and phones
Props	Whiteboards with project notes; flash drives; class routine pinned
External Sources	Students refer to course websites, GitHub, Google Docs, and MS Team
Lighting/Color	Mixed lighting – sometimes low-light dorms or harsh fluorescent lighting in labs. Plain-colored surroundings with little visual stimulation.
Clothing	Casual, student-appropriate attire, suggesting informal learning atmosphere

Synthesis with Interactive Methods (Anecdotal list)

Observation	Narrative	Symbol	Interpretation
Close to classrooms and labs, promoting academic-focused use	Students prefer working in academically supportive environments	✔ Tick	Confirms alignment with student study behavior
Shared cluttered cubicles or hostel desks	Students expressed concern about distractions and lack of personal space	■ Square	Modifies narrative – clutter contributes more to distraction than previously stated
Mostly laptops, notebooks, phones;	Students said they rely mostly on digital tools	✔ Tick	Confirms digital-first workflow
Whiteboards, flash drives, pinned routines	Students mentioned occasional use of visual aids or physical reminders	○ Circle	Supplements digital workflow with some analog support



Observation	Narrative	Symbol	Interpretation
Use of GitHub, Google Docs, MS Teams	Students need seamless access to shared external resources	✔ Tick	Confirms external integration is essential for collaboration
Moderate lighting, plain environment,	Students reported feeling the environment is uninspiring and causes mild fatigue	○ Eye	Cue to investigate UI aesthetics and lighting
Casual attire	Not directly mentioned in interviews	○ Eye	Cue to investigate whether casual environment affects professional seriousness



THANK YOU

ANY QUESTIONS